

San Fairy Ann Cycling Club Newsletter

August 2026

Creator Lorna Stafford

Welcome to the August edition of our Club Newsletter.

July was much quieter than last month... or perhaps nobody told me what's been going on!

Remember, if you've seen it, ridden it or done it, your fellow Fairies would like to know.

Don't be shy about sending me your small goals and big challenges; we'd love to hear about them.

SFA Ladies Away Day 26th July.



Jenny Burton's Great Idea!

And here it is.....

This is happening on the 2nd Wednesday of every month from 7.30 pm, starting in October.

14th October 🏆 11th November 🏆 9th December 🏆

The Bull PH, Boxley Road, Penenden Heath, Maidstone, ME14 2DH

A private room to the left of the main bar has been reserved for us.

See you there!

NEW CLUB EVENING MEET UP!

Everyone welcome!
A chance to connect, chat, plan and enjoy good company.

A DATE FOR YOUR DIARIES!

Going back in time when life wasn't so busy and we weren't all content to do something on devices.

The Fairies used to have a Club house – they would pop in and out at will, have regular meet-ups, chat, plan and of course, have a drink or two.

Everyone is so busy... well, not everyone. Some of us don't have the luxury of friends and family and with other people being so busy, it can be difficult to even find someone to have a coffee with.

So our lovely Jenny Burton has come up with an idea...

We will have a **CLUB WIDE MEET UP** once a month, at a pub – they serve coffee, so **NO EXCUSE!**

♥ An opportunity for the various Club race teams to get together, chat tactics and training.

♥ And for others to chat about anything they want, maybe organise a few of them on a cycling trip or whatever.

Come and stick your head round the door and see what you think!

Good chat
Great coffee
Brilliant company.
That's what we're about!

**COME FOR COFFEE, STAY FOR THE CHAT...
YOU'LL BE GLAD YOU DID!**

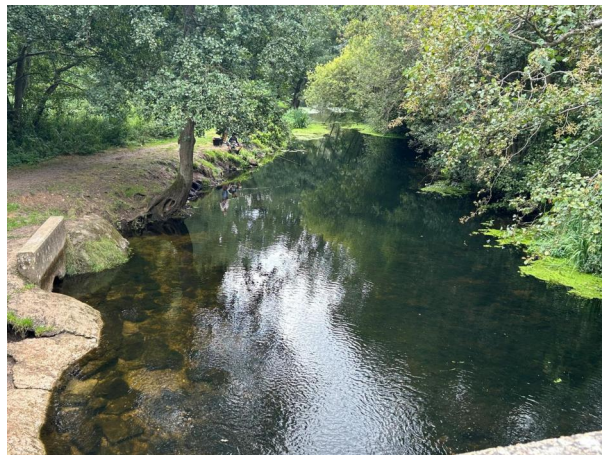
GOOD PEOPLE ♥ GREAT COFFEE ♥ BIG SMILES ♥ STRONGER TOGETHER

Three Days of Gravel, History and Hills

by Jeremy Roth.



1 - Paul Jenner, Matt Lacey, James Wilson, and Shaun Williams, all SFA members, ride with SFA A, Fast Inters, CX, and Gavel groups.





2 - Jeremy at the back!





Five friends from San Fairy Ann Cycling Club set off from Swaffham for a three-day adventure along the Rebellion Way, expecting a scenic gravel ride through Norfolk and perhaps a few gentle undulations.

What we hadn't quite appreciated was just how hilly Norfolk could be!

The Rebellion Way is a 232-mile circular route around Norfolk, taking in a fascinating mixture of quiet country lanes, bridleways, gravel tracks, sandy sections and historic sites. Our three-day adventure provided plenty of challenges, plenty of laughs and a few unexpected experiences along the way.

Day 1 – Swaffham to Walsingham

We set off from Swaffham with five riders, bikes loaded and spirits high. The route quickly took us away from the roads and onto a mixture of tracks and gravel paths.

Around 60% of our riding was on the road, with the remainder on gravel, sand and stones. Some sections were fast and enjoyable, while others were considerably more demanding, particularly when the surface became loose or sandy.

We also passed Sandringham, taking in another famous piece of Norfolk history before continuing on towards the coast and Walsingham.

Then came the weather!

It absolutely chucked it down on day one, providing a fairly brutal reminder that, despite what the BBC talks might suggest, we clearly all prefer sunshine and heat to cold and rain.

One of the great things about the Rebellion Way is the sheer variety of scenery and history. Along the way we passed ancient churches, historic buildings and castles, with reminders of Norfolk's long and sometimes turbulent past around almost every corner.

We also reached King's Lynn, where we saw the statue of Captain George Vancouver on Purfleet Quay, another fascinating historical stop on the route.

By the time we reached Walsingham, we were more than ready for the end of the first day. The village is famous for its religious history and the Catholic National Shrine of Our Lady of Walsingham, making it a fascinating place to spend the night.

And then things got even more interesting.

While we were in the pub, there was a power cut. With the lights out and not much else to do, we decided there was only one sensible course of action – drink beer until the power came back on!

As if that wasn't enough, we also bumped into another San Fairy Ann rider, **Peter Walton**, who was also riding the Rebellion Way. He recognised us from our SFA kit, proving once again that you can't escape San Fairy Ann riders; even when you're hundreds of miles from home!

It was a great end to a very wet and eventful first day.

Day 2 – Walsingham to Norwich

Day two brought more of what the Rebellion Way does best: quiet lanes, tracks, gravel and plenty of countryside.

We soon realised that our assumption that Norfolk would be relatively flat was becoming increasingly optimistic. There were far more climbs than we had expected, and by now the legs were beginning to feel the effects of the previous day.

The mixture of surfaces continued, with smooth tarmac giving way to gravel, stones and sandy tracks. It made for varied riding and kept everyone on their toes.

Eventually we arrived in Norwich, tired but pleased to have completed another demanding day.

There was, however, another important challenge to overcome: finding a decent ale in Norwich city centre.

What should have been a straightforward task turned into something approaching an expedition of its own. After all the miles, hills and gravel, the search for a proper pint became a matter of considerable importance. Eventually, we found somewhere suitable and could finally put our feet up.

Day 3 – Thetford and the Final Push

By the third morning, the legs were definitely aware that this was supposed to be a gravel adventure rather than a leisurely sightseeing tour!

We headed towards Thetford, continuing through the Norfolk countryside and encountering yet more variety in the landscape and terrain.

One of the highlights was riding along the Bure Valley Railway route between Aylsham and Wroxham. It was another reminder that this wasn't just a bike ride – we were effectively travelling through Norfolk's history as well as its countryside.

We also encountered the Desert Rats section, passing the military training area and museum. The tank tracks and military history provided another completely different dimension to the ride and made this one of the more memorable sections of the route.

By this stage, all five of us were feeling the accumulated miles, but the camaraderie kept us going. There was always someone ahead to chase, someone behind to wait for, and plenty of conversation, usually involving how much further it was to the finish!

Remarkably, despite three days of mixed surfaces and some pretty rough gravel, we had suffered almost no mechanical problems. The only real issue was a loose spoke, which we managed to get fixed at a bike shop in Aylsham.

A quick repair, a bit of fettling and we were back on the road.

More Than Just a Bike Ride

What made the Rebellion Way particularly memorable wasn't simply the riding. It was the variety.

Over three days, we experienced quiet Norfolk lanes, challenging gravel tracks, sandy trails, historic churches, castles, Sandringham, King's Lynn, Walsingham, Norwich, Thetford, and the Desert Rats' military history.

We rode through some beautiful countryside and alongside an historic narrow-gauge railway, battled rain, searched desperately for decent ale, survived a pub power cut, fixed a loose spoke and even bumped into a fellow San Fairy Ann rider doing exactly the same adventure.

Most importantly, we discovered that the Rebellion Way was considerably hillier than any of us had anticipated, and that Norfolk apparently has a very effective way of hiding its hills until you're already committed to climbing them!

For five friends from San Fairy Ann CC, it was a fantastic three-day adventure, challenging enough to feel like a proper expedition, but with plenty of laughs and memorable moments along the way.

Would we do it again?

Absolutely – although next time we might pay a little more attention to the elevation profile... and the weather forecast.

And as for the weather?

Let's just say that after day one, we were all firmly in agreement:

We like sunshine and heat. Drill, baby, drill! 🚲

The Welsh National 100-mile Championships

by Reuban Davey



Following the cancellation of the Southern Counties Cycling Union 100-mile time trial in Sussex due to roadworks, I decided to make the trip to Wales to compete in the Welsh National 100-mile Championships on the R100/9 course in Monmouth.

The course was primarily dual carriageway, with a few complex roundabouts and slip roads to navigate, as well as a section on an unclassified road through a local village.

My aim was to break four hours, so I paced myself accordingly. I was happy to maintain over 25 mph at each checkpoint, and this consistency paid off, resulting in a time of 3:55:10. This equated to an average speed of 25.5 mph for the 100 miles, a PB, and earned me 21st place overall.

Thanks to Autumn Richardson for being my soigneur, handing out bottles and providing support.

SFA LAUNCH THE LADIES RACING TEAM.



San Fairy Ann Cycling Club is officially launching a new women's road racing team for the 2027 season. This exciting expansion follows the successful reintroduction of the men's racing squad in 2026. The project aims to build a supportive environment for riders to test their fitness, learn race craft, and experience the thrill of competitive cycling.

What to Expect: The team focuses on growth, teamwork, and skill development on traffic-free circuits.

*** Zero experience required:** You do not need a racing background to join.

*** Core requirements:** A desire to be part of a team and a willingness to test your performance.

*** Skill building:** Riders will learn essential race craft and pack-riding techniques safely.

Membership Requirements:

To race, riders must be members of the SFA Club and hold a British Cycling Race License.

*** Club support:**

Don't worry if you don't have one yet. *** Full guidance:** The club will provide step-by-step directions on how to set this up.

Upcoming Awareness Sessions:

To help riders get a feel for circuit racing, the club is organising introductory sessions ahead of the season.

*** Location:**

The closed, traffic-free circuit at the [Cyclopark](<https://www.cyclopark.com/>). *** Timing:** Early next year (2027). *** Environment:** Completely safe, controlled, and free from vehicles.

How to Get Involved:

The team is currently being set up, and rider expressions of interest are fully open.

* **Contacts:**

Send a direct message to Jonathan Leeson or Autumn Richardson.

* **Learn More:**

Check out updates and race team details via the official [San Fairy Ann Racing Club](<https://sfaracing.club/>) platform.

Jonathan Leeson, Director

Time To Save Up -And Book Leave!

The problem with Club Holidays is that sometimes they can be quite short notice. Members simply don't have enough leave or money in the kitty to go off whenever they fancy. With that in mind, we are publishing a list of trips you might like to take, NOW!

SAVE THE DATES
San Fairy Ann Cycling Club Holidays

2027
MAY 27 *Portugal*
SUNSHINE, COASTAL ROADS & EPIC RIDES

2027
JULY 27 *Flanders*
COBBLES, CULTURE & CYCLING HISTORY

2028
MAY/JUNE 28 *Marden/Dover to Berlin*
A TRUE ADVENTURE. ONE CLUB, ONE JOURNEY.

2028
SEPTEMBER 28 *France*
TAKING IN SOME ICONIC CLIMBS & TOUR DE FRANCE ROUTES.
LEGENDARY CLIMBS. LEGENDARY MEMORIES.

MORE THAN A RIDE - IT'S WHAT WE DO! ♥

A Reminder From Almuñécar





Memories from Flanders.







Welcome to SFA.

GAVIN HALES

JAMES TAYLOR

JENNIFER SALTER

JULIAN SUTTON

Member Contributions

Here's a version that keeps the friendly tone while adding the practical requests:

A Reminder!

This newsletter is at its best when it includes **your** stories, not just mine.

If you've:

🚲 Been on a club ride

☕ Discovered a great café (or a terrible one...)

📍 Found a cracking route

📷 Taken some photos worth sharing

...then please send it in!

It doesn't have to be polished or poetic—a few lines are plenty. I can tidy it up if needed (that's my superpower).

One small favour: please send **the text and photos as separate files**, rather than as a finished page or layout. It makes it much easier for me to copy, edit and fit everything into the newsletter.

Also, please tell me **who's in the photos**, using **first and last names**, so I can give everyone the credit they deserve.

If you rode it, ate it, broke it, fixed it, or laughed about it afterwards, we'd love to hear about it.

Sharing is caring... and it saves me from having to make things up. 😊

Please send your articles and photos to Lorna via WhatsApp or email at membership@sanfairyanncc.co.uk.

Club Contacts

Richard Valentine - President 07505 262465

Duncan Edwards - Chair 07402 549927

Jonathan Engwell - Finance 07801 014877

Jonathan Leeson - Information Technology & Racing Team Lead - 07713 318186

Lorna Stafford - Membership & Events 07790 017482

Stephen Harmer - Events/Club Trips 07539 324565

Linton Schwarz - Club Kit 07901 851707

Emma Tuffey Director Of Club Runs & Events - 07976 262260

Jenny Burton - Club Welfare Officer - 07780 678201

Bob Watts - Sportives & Audax - bobwatts999@gmail.com

Veronica Harmer - Club Secretary & Events - 07910 265061

Tony Palmer - Training & Safety - 07786 393838